

CLI

Authentication

Cursor CLI supports two authentication methods: browser-based login (recommended) and API keys.

Browser authentication (recommended)

Use the browser flow for the easiest authentication experience:

```
1 # Log in using browser flow
2 agent login
3
4 # Check authentication status
5 agent status
6
7 # Log out and clear stored authentication
8 agent logout
```

The login command will open your default browser and prompt you to authenticate with your Cursor account. Once completed, your credentials are securely stored locally.

API key authentication

For automation, scripts, or CI/CD environments, use API key authentication:

Step 1: Generate an API key

Generate a user API key from [Cursor Dashboard](#) → [Integrations](#) under **API Keys**.

Step 2: Set the API key

You can provide the API key in two ways:

Option 1: Environment variable (recommended)

```
1 export CURSOR_API_KEY=your_api_key_here
2 agent "implement user authentication"
```

Option 2: Command line flag

```
agent --api-key your_api_key_here "implement user authentication"
```

Authentication status

Check your current authentication status:

```
agent status
```

This command will display:

- Whether you're authenticated
- Your account information
- Current endpoint configuration

Troubleshooting

- **"Not authenticated" errors:** Run `agent login` or ensure your API key is correctly set
- **SSL certificate errors:** Use the `--insecure` flag for development environments
- **Endpoint issues:** Use the `--endpoint` flag to specify a custom API endpoint



English ▾